BUG-001: Registration Failure (UTF-8/Accented Characters)

Component	Enrollment Form Frontend
Linked Test Case	TC-REG-02: Internationalization (i18n) Validation of Name Fields
Priority	P1 - High
Reported by	Ⓢ Santiago Diaz Ola
Severity	S2 - Major
Sprint	2026-Q1 Audit
Status	Open
Type	Internationalization (i18n)

Defect Overview

- **ID:** `BUG-001`
- **Module:** `User Acquisition / Registration`
- **Reported By:** Santiago Diaz Ola
- **Date:** March 19, 2026

Environment

- **OS:** macOS Sonoma
- **Browsers:** Chrome (v122.0), Safari (v17.2)
- **Endpoint:** `https://www.hilton.com/en/hilton-honors/join/`

Description

The registration form fails to process names containing accented characters (e.g., "í"). While standard alphanumeric strings (ASCII) are accepted, UTF-8 characters trigger a client-side validation failure, preventing account creation.

Steps to Reproduce

1. Navigate to the Hilton Honors Join page.
2. Populate required fields (Email, Phone, Password) with valid data.
3. In the **Last Name** field, enter a name with an accent: **Díaz**.
4. Click the **"Join for Free"** button.

Expected Result

The system should correctly encode UTF-8 characters and successfully process the registration payload.

Actual Result

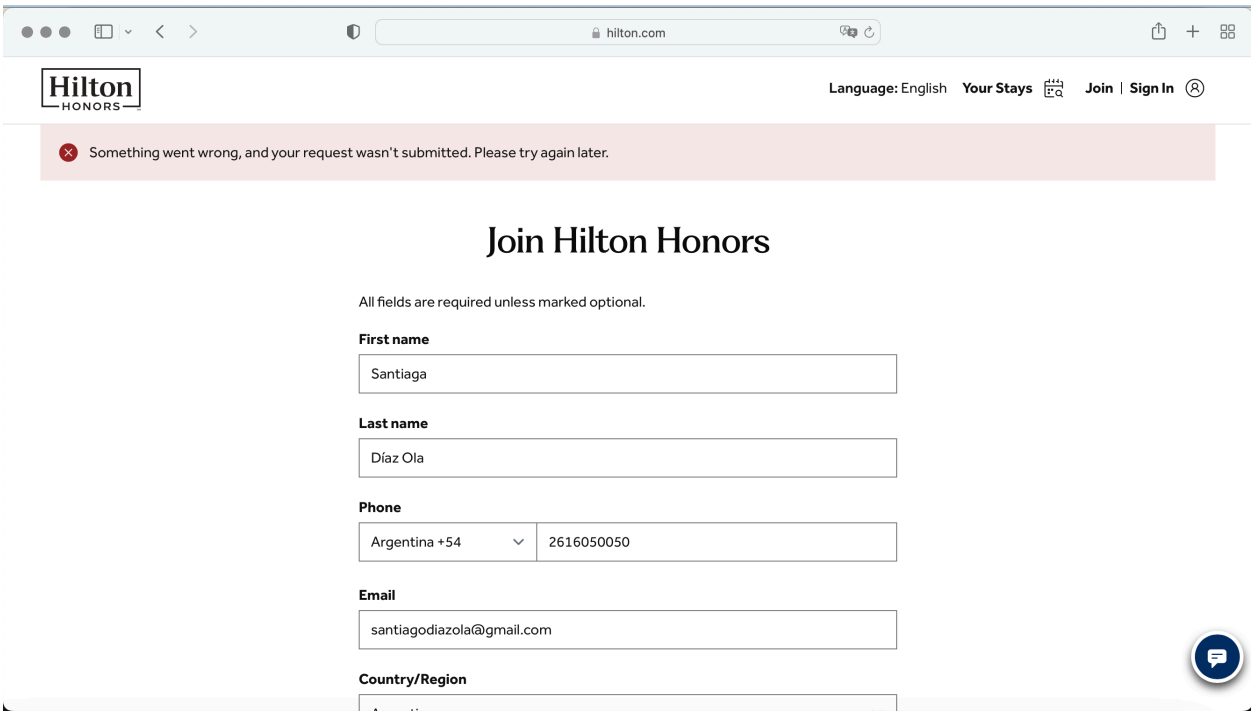
The UI displays a generic red banner: *"Something went wrong, and your request wasn't submitted. Please try again."*

> 🔍 **Technical Root Cause Analysis (RCA):**
> Network Tab audit confirms **zero outgoing XHR/Fetch requests** upon clicking the submit button. This indicates a **Client-Side Validation Gate** or a **Character Encoding Mismatch** in the frontend logic that interrupts the process before the data can be transmitted to the server.

Business Impact

- **Market Blocker:** High risk to customer acquisition in Latin American and European markets.
- **User Frustration:** High. Users are given a generic error without instructions on how to fix their "invalid" name.

Evidence & Attachments



Workaround

Removing the accent (e.g., "Diaz") allows the process to proceed. Note: This is an unacceptable workaround for a global hospitality brand as it requires users to misspell their legal names.